

McKinsey & Company

Rebuilding the consulting pyramid around AI agents in its centenary year — while cutting more than 10% of its people · www.mckinsey.com

1926

Founded

~40,000

People

~25,000

AI agents

~40%

Work that is AI

~\$16B

Revenue (2023)

01 Overview

The most prestigious strategy firm, and the one making the most aggressive claims about restructuring itself around AI. QuantumBlack, a 1,700-person unit, now drives initiatives accounting for roughly 40% of the firm's work

Offering: Strategy, operations, organisation and technology consulting, with QuantumBlack as the AI and advanced analytics arm and Lilli as the proprietary internal AI tool.

Key facts

HQ: New York, New York

Ownership: Private partnership

Revenue: Approximately \$16B for 2023 — disclosed once, in McKinsey's own announcement of Bob Sternfels' re-election, and not repeated since. No figure has been published for 2024 or 2025. MBB combined 2025 revenue is estimated at roughly \$36–40B across about 97,000 consultants, and reporting indicates McKinsey's growth flatlined following a period of rapid hiring

Web: www.mckinsey.com · [LinkedIn](#)

Key people: Bob Sternfels (Global Managing Partner) · Alex Singla (Senior Partner, Co-Lead of QuantumBlack)

Digital twin: No · **GenAI:** Yes (QuantumBlack, Lilli)

02 Use Cases & Reported Metrics

Sector	Deployment	Reported impact	Source
Firm operating model	AI agents deployed alongside consultants across delivery, with the stated goal of pairing every employee with one or more agents.	A workforce described as roughly 60,000 — about 40,000 humans plus 20,000 to 25,000 agents;	Link
AI delivery	QuantumBlack, the AI and advanced analytics unit, with a 1,700-person team driving the firm's AI initiatives, supported by proprietary tooling including Lilli and dedicated AI...	AI initiatives now account for approximately 40% of McKinsey's work	Link
Workforce restructuring	A reduction of roughly 10% of staff across non-client-facing departments over 18 to 24 months, announced around the October 2025 centenary events, while continuing to hire...	Headcount already down from about 45,000 at end-2023 to roughly 40,000 by May 2025, following flatlined revenue...	Link

03 Competitive Landscape

Other vendors in this market: Accenture · Aziro · Bain & Company · Booz Allen Hamilton · Boston Consulting Group · Capgemini · Cognizant · Deloitte

Where it sits: McKinsey is doing publicly what most of this peer set is doing quietly: shrinking the support base, holding or growing the client-facing pyramid, and filling the gap with agents. Sternfels' stated goal is every employee paired with one or more agents, and he has said he expects agent count to match human headcount.

04 GIP & BlackRock Connections

GIP became a wholly-owned BlackRock subsidiary in October 2024 and now operates as BlackRock's dedicated infrastructure-investment arm. Stakes below are standard institutional/index-fund positions unless otherwise noted.

Entity	Possible connection
Global Infrastructure Partners	No publicly disclosed GIP relationship. McKinsey works extensively with private equity and infrastructure owners, so an existing relationship at deal or fund level is plausible and would not be public.
BlackRock	None publicly disclosed.

05 Sentiment

Customer: Not assessable from public sources. McKinsey's client work is confidential and it publishes essentially no attributable case studies or outcome metrics.

What supports the story

- QuantumBlack is a genuine 1,700-person delivery capability, not a rebadged strategy practice
- AI initiatives reportedly account for around 40% of the firm's work — among the highest proportions claimed in this set
- The most explicit shift toward outcome-linked pricing of any strategy firm tracked here

What to pressure-test

- No revenue disclosure at all — nothing in the AI narrative can be tested against financial performance
- Headcount fell more than 10% in eighteen months, and a further ~10% cut to non-client-facing staff is under way
- Revenue growth reportedly flatlined before the restructuring, which is the context the AI story sits inside

Employee: The verifiable picture is contraction: roughly 45,000 people at the end of 2023 down to around 40,000 by May 2025, with a further 10% reduction in non-client-facing departments running over 18...